



Rep. Tom Emmer on Mornings with Maria

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MARIA BARTIROMO:

Joining me now is Minnesota Congressman and House Majority Whip Tom Emmer. Congressman, good to see you. Thank you so much for being here this morning. And I guess things are getting dicey with all these moves in commodities, oil prices where they are, fertilizer and aluminum, et cetera, et cetera. Your thoughts on the state of affairs today?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well, first off, Epic Fury is a bold move by the president to end a conflict literally that's been going on for almost a half a century, Maria. This is what people don't understand. This war has already been going for years. The brutal regime in Iran has killed more Americans than any other terrorist organization on the face of the planet. So kudos to President Trump and our amazing men and women in uniform that are taking this mission to destroy any offensive capability that Iran may have. And hopefully there'll be regime change soon, Maria.

MARIA BARTIROMO:

Yeah, and I agree. They've been yelling and screaming death to America for a long time and threatening Israel for even longer. But as an elected official, you've got to figure out how this calms down markets. We end this at some point and it doesn't affect your ability to hold on to the majority in several months in the midterms, right?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well, first off, you do the right thing for the right reason, which is what I think our president has done here. Politics are important, but this is about making sure the world is a safer place, not just for Americans, but for everyone, Maria, everyone in the region that Iran impacts. But as we go forward, this is a short term disruption in the markets. As we know, you had an earlier guest talk about the same kind of spike and volatility that we had during the Arab Spring. This too shall pass as soon as this settles down. And look, I'm bullish on the midterms. President Trump has delivered on the promises that he made and he's continuing to deliver. And as soon as this conflict is behind us, this mission has been accomplished. You'll see the economy once again be the focus on how it's taking off for all Americans. And that bodes well for Republicans in the midterms.

MARIA BARTIROMO:

Well, that sounds very practical and very smart. Thank you for that. Really, Congressman, I want to get your take on what comes next in terms of funding this war. I know that you and your colleagues are weighing a supplemental funding package to replenish U.S. stockpiles. Where are we on that? The Pentagon says it spent about 11 billion dollars on the Iran strikes just in the first week alone. They're planning to ask for a package upwards as 50 billion dollars, which has been my reporting. Does that sound like the right number?

REP. TOM EMMER:



Well, it could be more than that. Right now, the negotiations with the White House and the relevant personnel are taking place. We expect to see that supplemental request sometime in the very near future. And it's something, unfortunately, that Republicans are going to probably have to pass on their own because the Democrats are, frankly, deranged when it comes to President Trump's actions. They somehow want to stop him from doing anything in the office, and that's just not going to be acceptable. Look for a supplemental proposal to come within the next week or maybe a little bit more, and then look for Republicans to move that in the House and the Senate.

MARIA BARTIROMO:

Yeah, you're going to have to do that. I mean, you can't even get your colleagues to open up the Department of Homeland Security. I mean, airline CEOs are now criticizing Congress over this ongoing shutdown, now 30-plus days urging legislation to guarantee payment for TSA workers in any future shutdown. Democrats are rejecting GOP efforts to fund DHS, even despite the police investigating at least three terrorist attacks on American soil. As you know, you had Thursday's naturalized U.S. citizen from Lebanon ramming a car packed with explosives into a Michigan synagogue. Israeli forces say that the suspect's brother is a member of Hezbollah. Writing on X, he was, quote, responsible for managing weapons operations within a specialized branch of the Bader unit. The unit is responsible for launching hundreds of rockets towards Israeli civilians throughout this war. So, Congressman, what are you going to do to get DHS open, and where does that head next?

REP. TOM EMMER:

You know, it really is crazy. As you point out, it's now been closed for 30 days, a little bit more than a month. And look, we've got TSA agents that aren't getting paychecks. You've got three- to five-hour waits at major airports. You've got Coast Guard members not getting paid, and they're serving, some of them, in Bahrain in the midst of the conflict. It's unconscionable what Democrats are doing. They've got to get this done, and perhaps the Senate's got to look at something like a temporary rule when it comes to the filibuster, where when the government's not funded, you lift the filibuster and everything passes by a simple majority. That seems like a reasonable way to approach it. And as far as these naturalized domestic terror attacks, this is why Senator Eric Schmidt and I introduced the SCAM Act about a month ago, a little bit more. The law is about denaturalizing people who have come to this country a little too steep. If you have committed a felony, or if you have acted in concert with an international terrorist group, we should be able to denaturalize you and ship you back to where you came from, Maria. These are things that currently are not available to us, and it's something that we need to get done.

MARIA BARTIROMO:

Yeah. And meanwhile, House Republicans are giving the GOP senators an ultimatum on the Save America Act, saying, look, they're going to, are you in on this, that you'll block any legislation sent unless the Majority Leader John Thune brings the Save America Act to the floor for a debate and a vote? Where are you on the Save Act, sir?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well, actually, I'm all over the Save Act. Look at my state. President Trump has said this is an absolute priority of his. You take my state of Minnesota, where we don't have voter ID, Maria, and one person can vouch for up to eight people at a time to vote in a precinct on Election Day. It's outrageous. It's rife with problems when it comes to making sure that people who are supposed to vote are the actual people casting the vote. And when it comes to the House, yes, I'm going to be involved because I'm the whip and I got to count the votes. And I can tell you right now, we've got a small group of members who have made it very clear that they're not voting for



anything until the Senate gets the Save America Act passed into law.

MARIA BARTIROMO:

Well, how are you going to do it, though? You need the 60 votes and your colleagues on the left will not do it. I mean, you heard Chuck Schumer. He says it's dead on arrival.

REP. TOM EMMER:

Yeah, Chuck Schumer's insane. He's talking about someone proving their identity and their citizenship in order to vote. And he's saying that's somehow stealing an election, frankly, by blocking this. What Chuck Schumer is suggesting is that fraud is OK in American elections. We don't believe that. Eighty percent, 90 percent of Americans don't believe that. Time to pass the Save America Act.

MARIA BARTIROMO:

Unbelievable. Well, look, we're going to be watching this. I got to tell you, I posted a question to our viewers over the weekend. What do you want to hear more about? It was overwhelming. Everybody wanted to hear what the status is of the Save America Act. So you keep fighting. It's what the people want. Congressman, we appreciate your leadership. Thanks, Maria.

REP. TOM EMMER:

Thank you so much.

MARIA BARTIROMO:

Tom Emmer on Capitol Hill.

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